

Br. Ibrahim, French

Findings from the principal's review of student manuals and workbooks

To	Br. Ibrahim
Subjects	French, all levels
From	Mufti Mirza-Zain Baig, Principal
Date	Thursday, 11 September 2026

As Salam Alaykum Wa Rahmatullahi Wa Barakatuhu,

What I found

I went through the students' French manuals and workbooks this week and I am writing down what I noticed so that we are working from the same picture. The manual work is sporadic. A lot of questions are simply missing, some pages have a sentence written here and there and nothing else, and there is no sign that anyone verified whether the exercises were actually done. Where an activity was started it was not completed, and where work was completed there is no correction on it.

Chapter one is in noticeably better shape than the rest, the work is largely completed there, but even in chapter one I do not see corrections. Beyond that the manual becomes patchy again. The pace of movement through the chapters is fine, that is not the issue. The issue is what is being left behind on each page.

The writing is the part that concerns me most. It is not satisfactory. In the higher levels the students are not even attempting French, and what writing exists is completely broken. We are into the second week and I have not yet seen a written text from the students, and that is genuinely concerning at this point in the year.

Why it matters

French is the subject where the ministry and the parents will judge us most harshly, and the higher-level students cannot afford another year of avoidance. A manual that is half done with no correction tells me nothing about who is struggling and who is coasting, and it tells the student that the work does not count. Correction is where the learning actually happens.

What I expect moving forward

Every exercise assigned in the manual needs to be verified as done, not assumed. Missing questions are to be completed, not skipped over.

Every completed page needs to be corrected, with the correction visible on the page, chapter one included.

Make sure the exercise numbers you assign are the ones the students actually do, and organize the class so that manual time is protected.

Writing takes priority. I want regular written texts from every level starting now, and the higher levels need to be pushed to attempt French even when it is weak. Writing done in class has proven very helpful, keep it in class where you can see it.

Textbooks one and two are to be completed with no gaps. Get the textbooks in the students' hands and keep them there.

Where a student is clearly not doing the work versus clearly struggling, note it so we can separate the two and act accordingly.

I know the load is heavy at the start of the year and I appreciate the work you are putting in. Please go through your groups' manuals this week with the points above in mind and confirm with me once it is done. May Allah reward you and put barakah in your efforts.

Jazakallah khayra,

(Mufti) Mirza-Zain Baig

Principal, Dar Al-'Ulum Montreal